

Portfolio Build Plan — Shorif Ahmed Afridi Mozumder

A step-by-step playbook to build and publish a personal portfolio using **Claude Code**. Goal: simple, easy to read, important things highlighted, fully responsive — and built to tell a clear **career-pivot-into-GRC** story.

Locked decisions: Design = Refined Professional · Stack = Astro + Tailwind · Photography = a dedicated `/photography` gallery page (so the site is multi-page: home + gallery).

0. The strategy (read this first)

Your portfolio has one job: make a recruiter or hiring manager believe, in under 30 seconds, that you are a credible early-career **GRC / cybersecurity** candidate with a real technical foundation. Everything below serves that.

Three principles drive every decision in this plan:

- 1. **Lead with the pivot narrative.** Software Engineering → Networking → MSc Cybersecurity → GRC. Make it look intentional. Your missing roles (ISP Network Engineer, Teaching Assistant) are your *strongest* professional evidence — they go near the top, not the bike shop.
 - 2. **Be honest about being a student, but present strongly.** Don't fake GRC experience. Instead, show direction: thesis topic, a clearly-labeled certifications roadmap, and framing that shows you understand frameworks (ISO 27001, NIST CSF, risk, controls).
 - 3. **Curate, don't dump.** You have 32 repos; most are coursework. Show your best **4-6** with real context. A recruiter clicking through to a half-finished class project hurts more than helps.
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1. Recommended tech stack

Layer	Recommendation	Why
Framework	Astro (+ Tailwind CSS)	Ships almost no JS, top Lighthouse scores, perfect for a content/portfolio site. Has a built-in content layer for projects + an optional blog. "Secure-by-default static output" is itself a nice signal for a security candidate.
Styling	Tailwind CSS	Fast, consistent, responsive-first. Easy for Claude Code to keep tidy.

Layer	Recommendation	Why
Content	Astro Content Collections (Markdown/MDX)	Your projects, experience, and certs live as structured data/markdown — easy to add to later without touching layout.
Hosting	Cloudflare Pages or GitHub Pages	Both free. Cloudflare gives instant previews + easy custom domains; GitHub Pages fits your existing GitHub presence.
Domain (optional)	<code>ahmedafridi.com</code> , <code>afridimozumder.com</code> , or <code>afridi.dev</code>	A custom domain reads more professional than <code>*.github.io</code> . Optional for v1.

Simpler fallback: if you'd rather not learn a framework, plain **HTML + CSS + a little JS** works for a single-page portfolio. You lose the easy blog/projects-collection, but it's the lowest-maintenance option. The plan's prompts include notes for this path.

Heavier option (not recommended here): Next.js is overkill for a static portfolio and adds maintenance burden with no benefit for your use case.

2. Site architecture

A **single-page home** (anchored, sticky nav) plus a **dedicated** `/photography` **gallery page**. The nav includes a "Photography" link that routes to the gallery; the home page carries a small teaser that links there. Home sections, in order of importance (top = most important = most visually highlighted):

1. **Hero** — Name · "Cybersecurity · GRC" · one-line positioning · Copenhagen · primary actions (Download CV, LinkedIn, GitHub, Email).
2. **About** — the pivot narrative in 3-4 sentences. This is where you connect the dots.
3. **Focus / What I work toward** — GRC explicitly: frameworks you're learning, your thesis, the certifications roadmap. *This is the section that signals direction.*
4. **Experience** — Network Engineer (ISP) and Teaching Assistant FIRST, then Copenhagen roles framed for transferable skills (reliability, logistics under pressure, customer-facing).
5. **Education** — MSc Cybersecurity, Aalborg University · BSc Software Engineering, AIUB.
6. **Projects** — curated 4-6, each with: what it is, why you built it, what you learned. Thesis highlighted at the top.
7. **Certifications & Learning** — in-progress vs. planned, clearly labeled. Honesty = credibility.

8. **Photography & Travel (teaser)** — a small strip of 3-4 favorite shots with a "View gallery →" link to the dedicated `/photography` page. Low emphasis on the home page.

9. **Contact** — email, LinkedIn, GitHub, location, CV download.

Plus a separate page: `/photography` — the full gallery (see design notes in §3 and the build prompt in Phase 3).

Highlighting rule: Hero, Focus, and the top of Experience get the strongest visual weight (size, color accent, position). Hobbies get the least. Don't let everything shout — hierarchy is the design.

3. Design direction — Refined Professional (chosen)

Generous whitespace; a characterful display font (a refined serif or grotesque — **not** Inter/Roboto/Arial) paired with a clean, readable body font; ONE restrained accent color; subtle motion on load. Reads trustworthy and senior — the right register for GRC. Pick a distinctive type pairing as a starting point rather than a default system font, and keep the accent disciplined.

The gallery page stays consistent with this: calm, image-first, lots of breathing room — the photos provide the color, the chrome stays quiet. A clean responsive grid (or light masonry) with a lightbox, and optional grouping by country to tie in the travel angle.

Non-negotiables: light/dark friendly, WCAG AA contrast, real type hierarchy, no generic "purple-gradient-on-white" AI look, fast load.

4. The build, phase by phase (with Claude Code prompts)

Work **one section at a time**, commit to git after each, and review in the browser before moving on. Paste these prompts into Claude Code. Replace `[bracketed]` bits with your details.

Phase 0 — Prep your assets (do this before any code)

Gather into a folder:

- A clean headshot (you have one) and 6-12 of your best photography images (resized, ~1600px wide).
- Your **fresh CV as PDF** (the portfolio links to it).
- Final text for: About paragraph, the two missing roles (ISP + TA) with dates and 2-3 bullets each, thesis title + one-line description, target certifications (in-progress / planned), and your chosen 4-6 projects with a one-line "what I learned" each.

- Decide: custom domain or not; Cloudflare Pages or GitHub Pages.

Tip: Before building, spend 30 minutes writing real READMEs for your 4-6 chosen repos — recruiters click through. You can ask Claude Code: *"Write a clear README for this repo explaining what it does, the stack, and what I learned, in a professional but plain tone."*

Phase 1 — Scaffold + install the skill

Set up a new Astro project with Tailwind CSS for my personal portfolio. I've placed a Claude Code skill at `.claude/skills/portfolio-builder/SKILL.md` — read it first; it has my real content, the design system, and the rules to follow. Initialize a git repo, create a sensible folder structure (components, sections, content collections for projects/experience/certs), and a `CLAUDE.md` at the root summarizing the project conventions. Don't build any sections yet — just the skeleton, the layout shell, the design tokens (fonts, colors, spacing), and a running dev server. Then show me the empty styled shell.

Phase 2 — Content/data layer

Create the content layer described in the portfolio-builder skill: structured data files (Markdown/MDX content collections) for experience, education, projects, and certifications, plus a single site config for my name, taglines, and links. Populate them with the real content from the skill. Keep layout out of this step — just clean, well-typed data I can edit later without touching components.

Phase 3 — Build sections (one prompt per section)

Hero:

Build the Hero section per the skill's design direction and hierarchy rules. Name, the "Cybersecurity · GRC" positioning line, a one-sentence value statement, Copenhagen location, and primary actions (Download CV, LinkedIn, GitHub, Email). This is the most visually weighted element on the page. Make it responsive and add one tasteful staggered load animation. Show me mobile and desktop.

About + Focus:

Build the About section (the pivot narrative) and the Focus section (GRC: frameworks, thesis, and what I work toward). Focus is a key credibility section – give it strong visual hierarchy. Keep copy tight and confident, honest about being a student.

Experience + Education:

Build Experience and Education. Order experience by relevance, NOT date: Network Engineer (ISP) and Teaching Assistant first, then the Copenhagen roles framed for transferable skills. Use the content collection data. Make it scannable on mobile.

Projects:

Build the Projects section from the projects collection – only the curated 4-6. Each card: title, one-line what-it-is, the stack, and a one-line "what I learned", with a link to the repo. Highlight the thesis project at the top. No grid of 32 repos.

Certifications + Photography teaser + Contact (home):

Build three home sections: (1) Certifications & Learning, clearly splitting in-progress vs planned; (2) a small Photography & Travel TEASER – 3-4 favorite images with a "View gallery →" link to /photography; (3) Contact with email, LinkedIn, GitHub, location, and CV download. Add a "Photography" link to the site nav that routes to /photography.

Dedicated gallery page (</photography>):

Create a dedicated /photography page consistent with the Refined Professional design:
calm, image-first, generous spacing. Build a responsive grid (or light masonry) of my photos with a click-to-open lightbox (keyboard accessible, Esc to close). Optionally group images by country to tie in the travel angle. Use Astro's <Image> for responsive srcset, lazy loading, and modern formats so the page stays fast even with many photos. Pull image data from a simple photos collection/manifest so I can add shots later without touching layout.

Phase 4 — Responsive + accessible + dark mode

Audit the whole site for responsiveness across mobile, tablet, and desktop, and fix any issues. Ensure WCAG AA contrast, keyboard navigation, focus styles, alt text on all images, and semantic landmarks. Add a light/dark mode toggle that respects the system preference. Show me the trouble spots you found and fixed.

Phase 5 — Polish, SEO, and meta

Add SEO and social polish: per-page <title> and meta description, Open Graph + Twitter card tags, a generated OG image with my name and "Cybersecurity · GRC", a favicon, sitemap, robots.txt, and JSON-LD Person schema. Keep animations subtle and purposeful.

Phase 6 — Performance + accessibility audit

Run a production build and help me get Lighthouse scores into the 90s+ across Performance, Accessibility, Best Practices, and SEO. Optimize and lazy-load images, check bundle size, and report before/after numbers with what you changed.

Phase 7 — Deploy

GitHub Pages path:

Set up deployment to GitHub Pages via GitHub Actions: build on push to main, deploy the Astro static output, and configure the correct base path. Walk me through pushing the repo and confirm the live URL.

Cloudflare Pages path:

Give me step-by-step instructions to deploy this Astro site to Cloudflare Pages by connecting my GitHub repo (build command, output directory, env). Then how to add a custom domain and HTTPS.

Phase 8 — Maintain

Document in CLAUDE.md exactly how I add a new project, a new certification, or a new experience entry later — which file to edit and the field format — so I can do it in two minutes without breaking anything.

5. Working effectively with Claude Code

- **Keep a** `CLAUDE.md` **at the repo root** (conventions, stack, "don'ts"). Claude Code reads it automatically every session — it's your project memory.
- **The skill is your source of truth for content + design.** Update it if your facts change (new cert earned, thesis title finalized) and Claude Code stays accurate.
- **Commit per section.** `git commit` after each working piece so you can always roll back.
- **Iterate visually.** After each section, look at it on your phone before moving on.
- **One change at a time.** "Now make the hero font larger on mobile" beats a giant rewrite prompt.

6. Pre-launch checklist

- ☐ CV PDF linked and downloads correctly
- ☐ ISP Network Engineer + Teaching Assistant roles included and dated
- ☐ Only curated 4–6 projects shown; each linked repo has a real README

- ☐ Thesis highlighted; certs split into in-progress vs planned (no overclaiming)
 - ☐ Looks right on a real phone, tablet, and desktop
 - ☐ Dark/light mode works; AA contrast passes
 - ☐ All images have alt text and are optimized
 - ☐ Meta tags, OG image, favicon, sitemap present
 - ☐ Lighthouse 90s+ across the board
 - ☐ Links (LinkedIn /in/ahmedafриди, GitHub, email) all work
 - ☐ No typos (read it out loud once)
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7. Note on the fresh CV

Your portfolio content and your CV draw from the same well. The structured content you write for

Phase 0 — especially the two missing roles, the thesis line, and the certs roadmap — is exactly what a strong one-page GRC-oriented CV needs. Build the content once, use it in both. (I can help

you produce the fresh CV as a polished document whenever you're ready.)